

The Surge Levels Off

Maryland Market Intelligence | Week of August 31 - September 6, 2026

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A hyperlocal, data-driven weekly Maryland market report. This week's edition is a PDF in place of the usual interactive deck.

The Story of the Week

Renee and Theo Alvarez started looking in April.

By mid-July they had been outbid three times, once by \$40,000 over asking on a house they had walked through for eleven minutes. They decided to sit the rest of the summer out and come back when things calmed down.

They came back the week after Labor Day, and the market did feel different. Not soft, exactly, but different. There were 2,016 new listings across Maryland that week, and for the first time all year Renee was not refreshing the app at 6 a.m. afraid something would be gone by breakfast. Homes were taking a little longer to go under contract, a median of 21 days statewide, up from 18 the week before. And 2,098 listings had cut their asking price.

The house they liked was in Frederick County, where the median sale landed at about \$484,000 this week. It had been on the market a little over three weeks and the sellers had already trimmed the price once. Theo wanted to come in low. But their lender's quote had just moved from 6.66% to 6.71%, and on a 30-year note every eighth of a point is real money. So instead of a lowball they offered near the reduced list price, asked the sellers to cover part of the closing costs, and locked their rate that same afternoon.

It was accepted in two days. Not because they won a bidding war, but because this week, on that house, there wasn't one to win.

Here is what I would tell Renee and Theo, and anyone else reading this week's numbers: the surge that defined late August did not reverse. It just stopped accelerating. The same elevated volume is still moving through the market, but prices gave a little back, homes are sitting a few days longer, and the rate is working against buyers again. That is a market leveling off, not turning. For a buyer with a rate lock in hand, it is the friendliest week we have seen since spring. For a seller, it is the week the market started grading your list price a lot more strictly.

Maryland in 60 Seconds

HOMES SOLD 1,150 +1.1%	NEW LISTINGS 2,016 flat -0.1%	PENDING 518 +5.7%	MEDIAN SOLD PRICE \$440,000 -2.2%
MEDIAN DAYS TO CONTRACT 21 days +3 from 18	PRICE REDUCTIONS 2,098 +0.4%	30-YR FIXED RATE 6.71% +5 bp	FMMI SCORE 52 / 100 -6 from 58

Methodology: "Median Days to Contract" uses this report's own weekly Bright MLS pull (median CDOM for Closed sales); the 18 → 21 comparison is consistent week to week on that basis. This week's pull covered 23 of 24 counties — Howard County was not included and is marked pending below (roughly 63 closings, backed out of the statewide total).

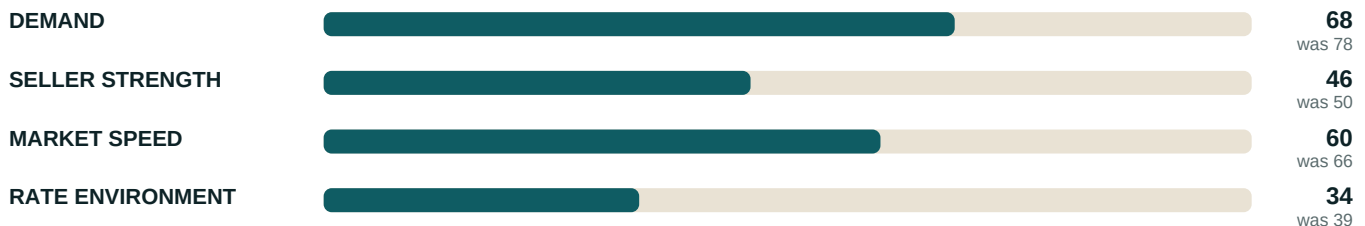
What the Numbers Really Mean

The surge held its level but lost its momentum. Last week Maryland posted its sharpest one-week jump in activity all year, with closings and new listings both nearly doubling. This week that volume essentially held in place: closings edged up 1.1% to 1,150, new listings were flat at 2,016, and pending contracts rose another 5.7% to 518. Nothing collapsed. But nothing accelerated either. The market found a plateau.

Pricing softened at the edges. The median sold price slipped 2.2% to \$440,000, giving back last week's \$10,000 gain, and the median new-listing price fell by the same \$10,000, to \$419,900. Closed homes still realized a median 99.0% of their original list price, so this is a gentle give-back, not a rollover. But paired with 2,098 price reductions and a slower time-to-contract, the direction is clear: buyers picked up a little leverage this week, and sellers lost a little.

The Friedman Market Momentum Index (FMMI)

52 / 100 — Balanced Market, Momentum Cooling (down from 58 last week)



Maryland's market did not tip toward buyers this week so much as it stopped tipping toward sellers. Transaction volume is still high, which keeps the index in balanced territory, but every one of the four components softened. This is the first FMMI decline in three weeks, and a broad one rather than a single-factor drop.

- **Demand 68** (from 78) — Closings held at 1,150 and pending rose 5.7% to 518. Demand is still strong in absolute terms, but last week's near-doubling momentum is gone.
- **Seller Strength 46** (from 50) — Median sold price fell 2.2% and the median new-listing price fell the same \$10,000, while reductions held at an elevated 2,098.
- **Market Speed 60** (from 66) — Median days-to-contract slowed from 18 to 21. Still fast historically, but decelerating.
- **Rate Environment 34** (from 39) — The Freddie Mac 30-year fixed rose five basis points to 6.71%, its second straight weekly increase.

The Friedman Signal: Leveling

The surge did not reverse this week. It leveled off. Last week Maryland saw its sharpest one-week jump in activity all year, closings and new listings both nearly doubling. This week that volume held almost exactly in place: 1,150 closings, 2,016 new listings, 518 pending. But the momentum behind it flattened. Median sold price gave back \$10,000, homes took three days longer to reach contract, and the mortgage rate rose for a second straight week. A surge that keeps surging is a trend. A surge that holds its level and stops climbing is a plateau, and that is what this week looked like. Watch two things next week: whether volume stays near 1,150 closings and 2,000 new listings, and whether the median price stabilizes or keeps sliding.

Market Spotlight: Carroll County & Harford County

Carroll County

Carroll County closed 44 homes this week at a \$533,000 median, and here is the number that stands out: closed homes sold at an average of 101.0% of their *original* list price. Not their reduced price, their first one. In a week when the statewide median fell and price cuts stayed elevated, Carroll sellers were still beating their opening ask. The average days on market reads 30, but the median is 10 — the typical Carroll home is going under contract fast, with a few longer-sitting listings pulling the average up. Kyle's home county remains one of the tightest in the state.

Closed: 44 | Median Sold: \$533,000 | Avg. DOM: 30 (median 10) | Sold / Orig. List: 101.0%

Harford County

Harford County posted the fastest pace in Maryland this week: a 25-day average days on market across 55 closings, at a \$395,000 median. That is real speed on a real sample, not a small-county fluke. Homes there sold at a median 100.0% of list price. For buyers priced out of Baltimore County or looking for more house per dollar within commuting range, Harford is moving quickly and cleanly right now.

Closed: 55 | Median Sold: \$395,000 | Avg. DOM: 25 | Sold / List: 100.0%

Bottom line: Carroll is winning on price and Harford is winning on speed, and both are doing it in a week when the statewide numbers softened. Strength in this market is local, and right now it is concentrated north of Baltimore.

This Week's Price Extremes

No individual listing sheet was provided this week, so these are statewide aggregate values from the Bright MLS pull rather than specific named properties.

- **Priciest sale:** \$6,250,000 (originally listed \$6,950,000) — the highest closed price in the state this week, up from last week's top closing of \$2,950,000.
- **Most affordable sale:** \$7,000 — the low end of the range, almost certainly land or a shell-condition rehab.
- **New listings this week** ranged from \$2,250 to \$7,445,000 in original list price.

Friedman Heat Map: Fastest & Slowest Counties

Hottest — Fastest Average DOM

County	Avg. DOM	Closings
Harford County	25 days	55
Anne Arundel County	28 days	124
Frederick County	29 days	74
Montgomery County	30 days	148
Baltimore County	30 days	136

Carroll County also posted a 30-day average on 44 closings, with a median DOM of just 10 (see Market Spotlight).

Cooling — Slowest Average DOM

County	Avg. DOM	Closings
Talbot County	128 days	16
Garrett County	114 days	19
Kent County	76 days	10

Dorchester County	74 days	11
Worcester County	56 days	32

Talbot and Garrett, both higher-priced, second-home-heavy markets, sit well clear of the rest of the state on time-to-sell. Dorchester lands near the bottom for a third straight week, though it actually got a little faster (85 → 74 days). Pace right now is strongest in the counties ringing Baltimore and weakest on the rural Eastern Shore and in far Western Maryland. *Howard County: data pending this week.*

Week Over Week

Metric	Last Wk (8/24-8/30)	This Wk (8/31-9/6)	Change
Closed Sales (Statewide)	1,137	1,150	+13 (+1.1%)
New Listings	2,019	2,016	-3 (-0.1%)
Pending Contracts	490	518	+28 (+5.7%)
Price Reductions	2,090	2,098	+8 (+0.4%)
Median Sold Price	\$450,000	\$440,000	-\$10,000 (-2.2%)
Median New-Listing Price	\$429,900	\$419,900	-\$10,000 (-2.3%)
Days to Contract (Closed CDOM)	18	21	+3 days
30-Year Mortgage Rate	6.66%	6.71%	+5 bp

The volume metrics essentially flatlined at last week's elevated level, while every price and pace metric ticked the wrong way for sellers. A week of small moves, all pointed the same direction.

Winners & Losers This Week

Winners

- **Buyers with a rate lock in hand** — 2,016 new listings, a slower pace, and 2,098 price reductions to negotiate against.
- **Harford County** — fastest market in Maryland, 25-day average across 55 closings, homes selling at full list.
- **Carroll County** — closed homes sold at an average 101.0% of original list price, \$533,000 median, still beating opening ask.

Losing Momentum

- **Seller Strength** — down to 46 from 50; median price off 2.2%, reductions still elevated at 2,098.
- **Rate-sensitive buyers** — 6.66% → 6.71%, the second straight weekly increase.
- **Talbot County** — 128-day average days on market as high-end Eastern Shore inventory sits.

One Thing I'd Do This Week

If I were buying: Get the rate lock first, then shop. The rate is trending up, but the extra inventory and the 2,098 price cuts mean you can push on price and terms in a way you could not in July. Spend your leverage on the contract, not on waiting for a better week.

If I were selling: Price to your first number, not your second. The homes that needed a cut this week are the ones still sitting. The ones priced right on day one are still going under contract in about three weeks at essentially full ask (99.0% of original list, median, statewide).

If I were investing: Look where days on market is stretching — Talbot (128), Garrett (114), Kent (76), Dorchester (74). Thinner buyer pools and longer holds, but that is also where the motivated sellers and the real negotiating room are right now.

Deep Dive: The Surprising Fact This Week

2,098 price reductions vs. 2,016 new listings. For the second week in a row, Maryland sellers cut prices on more homes than came onto the market — against 1,150 closings. That means for every home that actually sold, nearly two others had their asking price lowered.

It is the clearest sign yet that the inventory that piled on during August's surge was priced for a hotter market than the one buyers are shopping now. Sellers who listed into the late-August rush are recalibrating in real time. (The reduction count reflects any price-decrease event in the seven-day window, not unique properties — but two straight weeks of cuts outnumbering new supply is not noise.)

Bonus From My Kitchen: Maryland Crab & Corn Chowder

The first cool nights of September, the last of the local sweet corn, and crab still running in the Bay. There is exactly one week a year this dish is perfectly in season, and this is it. **Serves 4-6.**

Ingredients: 4 strips bacon, chopped; 1 medium onion, diced; 2 celery stalks, diced; 3 tbsp flour; 4 cups seafood or chicken stock; 2 medium Yukon Gold potatoes, peeled and diced; 3 ears fresh corn, kernels cut off (about 2 cups); 1 cup heavy cream; 1 lb Maryland lump crab meat, picked over; 1 tsp Old Bay, plus more to taste; salt and pepper; chopped chives or parsley.

1. Cook the bacon in a heavy pot over medium heat until crisp. Remove and set aside, leaving the fat in the pot.
2. Cook the onion and celery in the fat until soft, about 5 minutes. Stir in the flour and cook 1 minute more.
3. Whisk in the stock a little at a time so it stays smooth. Add the potatoes, simmer until tender, about 12 minutes.
4. Add the corn and cream and simmer 5 minutes.
5. Gently fold in the crab and Old Bay and warm through, about 2 minutes. Do not let it boil hard or the crab toughens.
6. Season with salt, pepper, and more Old Bay to taste. Serve topped with the crispy bacon and chives.

Crusty bread and a green salad make it dinner. It reheats well; add the crab fresh to each reheated bowl if you can.

Let's Talk

Whether you're thinking about selling or searching for your next home, the right information makes all the difference. Ask for a real, data-backed valuation of your home, or set up live MLS alerts for exactly what you're looking for.

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Why Choose Kyle: 80% more views than comparable listings • 5,000+ calls a month to find your buyer • cinematic video and best-in-class photography • Zillow Showcase premium placement • an investor's mindset on every deal since 2018.

Equal Housing Opportunity. Kyle Friedman is a licensed Maryland real estate agent. Data source: Bright MLS, week of August 31 - September 6, 2026 (23 of 24 counties; Howard County pending). Mortgage rate: Freddie Mac PMMS, released September 3, 2026.